WEEK 16 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

E-Commerce & Conversion

Product pages, feeds, checkout and CRO testing for Mauritian online shops

Avinesh Bundhoo & Fareez Fawdar · Oreegami Mauritius · October 2026



Inside this guide

1 E-commerce in Mauritius
2 Business models and platforms
3 Payments in Mauritius
4 Delivery, returns and trust
5 KPIs and unit economics
6 Funnel and GA4 events
7 Home, categories and search
8 The product page
9 Photos, video and copy
10 Reviews, UGC and trust
11 Pricing, promotions, bundles
12 Cart and checkout
13 Mobile commerce and speed
14 Feeds and Merchant Center
15 Meta and WhatsApp catalogues
16 Retention: flows, loyalty
17 The CRO method
18 Quantitative research (GA4)
19 Clarity and user research
20 Writing hypotheses
21 Prioritising: ICE and PIE
22 A/B testing tools, set-up
23 Statistics basics
24 Results and personalisation
25 Legal and compliance
26 Case study: Lakaz Zepis
27 FAQ
28 Exercises and capstone
29 Worksheets and templates
30 Glossary and checklists

PART A

E-commerce foundations

The Mauritian market, platforms, payments, delivery, unit economics and tracking

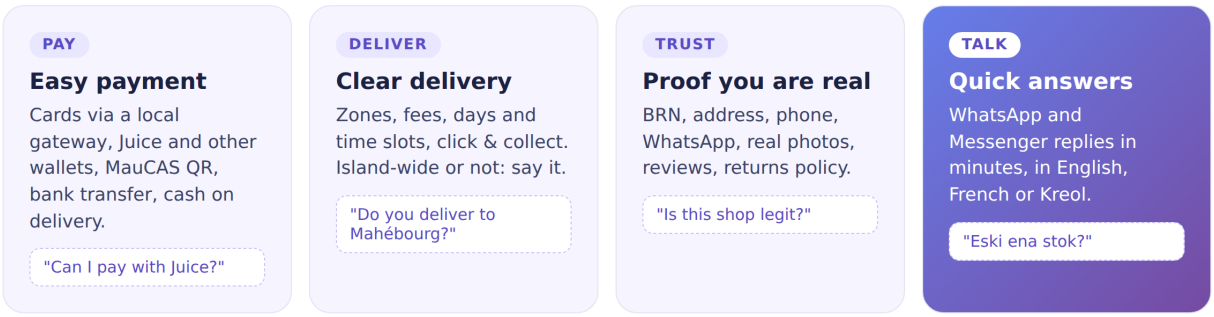
SECTION 1

E-commerce in Mauritius

E-commerce means selling products or services online, where the customer chooses and (usually) pays on a website, an app or a marketplace. In Mauritius it has grown from a niche into a normal way to shop for food, gifts, fashion, electronics, beauty and services. This week you learn how to run an online shop that converts visitors into buyers, and how to improve it every month with tests instead of guesses.

Selling online in Mauritius: the four things customers check

Small market, mobile-first, high trust needs. Win on the basics before you spend on ads



The market in numbers

According to DataReportal's *Digital 2026: Mauritius* report, there were about **1.01 million internet users** at the end of 2025 (79.5% of the population), about **886,000 social media user identities** and around **2.25 million mobile connections** (more than one per person). In practice that means: almost everyone you want to sell to is online, mostly on a phone, and discovers products on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok and Google.

What is special about Mauritius	What it means for your online shop
Small market (about 1.27 million people)	You cannot rely on huge traffic. Every visitor counts, so conversion rate and repeat purchases matter more than in big markets.
Mobile-first shoppers	Design, test and measure on a phone first. Most of your sales problems will be mobile problems.
Strong habit of ordering by WhatsApp and Messenger	Your shop must work with chat, not against it: WhatsApp buttons, quick replies, order links.
Trust is fragile (fake pages, scams, late deliveries)	Show who you are: BRN (Business Registration Number), address, phone, real photos, reviews, clear policies.
Mixed payment habits: cards, Juice and other wallets, bank transfer, cash	Offer more than one way to pay. A missing payment method is a lost order.
Island-wide delivery is possible, but slots and zones vary	State fees, delivery days and zones before the cart, not at the end.
Bilingual (EN/FR) with Kreol in conversations	Product pages in English and French where your buyers need it; Kreol in social and chat.
Competition from global marketplaces and parcels from abroad	Compete on speed, local relevance, service, gifting and trust, not only on price.

> **In Mauritius:** many successful local shops started as an Instagram page with WhatsApp orders, then moved to a website when orders became too many to handle manually. The website does not replace chat: it handles the catalogue, the prices, the payment and the tracking, so that chat time is spent on real questions.

What this week covers

Part A covers the foundations (platforms, payments, delivery, the numbers behind a profitable order, and tracking with GA4). Part B covers the shopping experience page by page, feeds and retention. Part C teaches **CRO (conversion rate optimisation)**: the method for finding problems, writing hypotheses, prioritising and running A/B tests. Part D brings it together in a case study and your deliverable: an **E-Commerce Growth Plan** with five hypothesis-driven tests.

SECTION 2

Business models and platforms

Before talking about conversion, decide where you sell. Most Mauritian businesses use a mix: their own website as the base, social media for discovery and chat, and sometimes a marketplace or delivery app for extra reach.

Model	Examples	Strengths	Watch out for
Your own online shop	Shopify, WooCommerce, Wix stores	You own the customer data, brand and margin; full tracking; no commission per order	You must bring the traffic and build trust yourself
Social commerce	Instagram/Facebook posts + WhatsApp or Messenger orders, WhatsApp catalogue	Fast start, close relationship, no website needed	Manual, hard to scale, little data, orders get lost in chats
Marketplaces and delivery apps	Local marketplaces, food and grocery delivery apps	Existing traffic and trust, they handle part of the logistics	Commission, less control over price and brand, customer belongs to the platform
Hybrid (most common)	Website + WhatsApp + marketplace for some products	Reach and control	Keep prices, stock and messages consistent everywhere

Choosing an e-commerce platform

In Week 2 you compared website platforms. For a shop, look at the questions below. There is no single best platform; the best one is the one your team can run every day and that connects to the payment methods your customers use.

Platform	Best for	Strengths	Watch out for
Shopify	Product shops that want to start fast and grow	Hosting, security, checkout and apps included; strong feeds to Google and Meta; native GA4 integration	Monthly plan + app fees; Shopify Payments is not available for Mauritius-based businesses, so you use a third-party gateway

Platform	Best for	Strengths	Watch out for
WooCommerce (WordPress)	Businesses already on WordPress, content-rich shops	Free plugin, very flexible, many local gateway plugins	You manage hosting, updates, speed and security
Wix / Squarespace stores	Small catalogues, service businesses adding a few products	Simple drag-and-drop	Fewer local payment options and advanced features; check gateways first
Custom or marketplace software	Large retailers, special needs	Anything is possible	Cost, dependence on developers, tracking must be built properly

Questions to ask before you choose

1. Which payment gateways and wallets used in Mauritius have a ready plugin for this platform (Section 3)?
2. Can it handle delivery zones by district, time slots, click and collect and free-delivery thresholds?
3. Does it send GA4 e-commerce events properly, and can you add Microsoft Clarity and the Meta Pixel?
4. Can it create product feeds for Google Merchant Center and a Meta catalogue (Section 14)?
5. Does it support English and French product pages and prices in rupees (MUR)?
6. What is the full yearly cost: plan, theme, apps or plugins, gateway fees, developer time?

> **Tip:** start with the platform and the payment method, not the design. A beautiful shop that cannot take Juice or card payments easily will lose to a plain shop that can.

SECTION 3

Payments in Mauritius

Payment is where many Mauritian shops lose orders. Shoppers want to pay the way they already pay every day. Your job is to offer the right mix and make it visible early.

Payment options for a Mauritian online shop

Offer what your customers already use; add more as you grow. Always check fees and settlement with each provider

CARDS

Card payment gateway

Visa and Mastercard through a local gateway (e.g. MIPS, Peach Payments) or your bank's e-commerce gateway.

Plugins for Shopify, WooCommerce, Wix...

WALLETS

Mobile wallets

Juice (MCB) and other local wallets and bank apps, often via a gateway or a MauCAS QR code.

Instant, no card needed

TRANSFER

Bank transfer

Customer pays by internet banking; you confirm the order when the money arrives.

Cheap but slower; manual checks

ON DELIVERY

Cash or card on delivery

Builds trust for first orders; costs you in failed deliveries and cash handling.

Limit by order value or area

INTERNATIONAL

Global options

PayPal for foreign buyers where it fits. Stripe and Shopify Payments do not onboard Mauritius-based businesses.

Check before you choose a platform

RULE

Show the logos early

Display accepted methods on product, cart and checkout pages, not only at the last step.

"Juice, cards, COD"

The main options

Option	How it works	Good to know
Card payment gateway	A company that processes card payments on your site. Local options include **MIPS** (Shopify app and WooCommerce plugin) and **Peach Payments** (plugins for Shopify, WooCommerce, Wix and others); several banks also offer e-commerce gateways.	Compare set-up fees, % per transaction, settlement time (when the money reaches your account) and 3-D Secure (the extra check by the bank). Fees are usually agreed with the provider.
Juice (MCB) and other wallets	The customer pays from a mobile banking or wallet app. Since 2024, Peach Payments offers Juice at checkout for online merchants.	Very popular for local payments; instant confirmation. Check which wallets your gateway supports (Juice, Blink by Emtel, my.t money and others).
MauCAS QR	The national QR code standard of the Bank of Mauritius, launched in 2021, designed to be interoperable across banks.	Customers scan a QR with their banking app. Some gateways offer it at online checkout.
Bank transfer	The customer transfers the amount; you ship after checking your account.	Cheap, but slow and manual; risk of orders never paid.
Cash or card on delivery (COD)	The customer pays the driver.	Builds trust for first orders but costs you in refused deliveries, cash handling and driver time. Many shops limit it by value or area.
PayPal / international	Useful if you sell abroad (France, Réunion, diaspora).	**Stripe and Shopify Payments do not currently onboard Mauritius-based businesses**; check before following a foreign tutorial.

> Payment providers change their offers often. Before you build, ask each provider in writing: which payment methods are included (cards, Juice, other wallets, QR), which platform plugins exist, the fees, the settlement time and how refunds work. Then test a real payment on mobile before launch.

Make payments convert

- Show payment logos on the product page, cart and footer: people decide before they reach checkout.
- Put the most used local method first. For many local shops that is Juice or card; for gifts bought from abroad, card or PayPal.
- Explain what happens next: "You will be redirected to the secure MIPS / bank page, then back to our site."
- Watch for the redirect drop-off: in GA4, compare **add_payment_info** with **purchase** (Section 6). A big gap often means a payment page that fails or confuses on mobile.
- If you offer COD, confirm the order by WhatsApp or SMS before dispatch to reduce refused deliveries.

SECTION 4

Delivery, returns and trust

In a small island, delivery is part of the product. A clear, fast and fairly priced delivery promise often converts better than a discount.

Your delivery options

Option	When it fits	Tips
Own delivery (staff or driver)	Food, cakes, fragile items, local zones	Group orders by region and day; send an "out for delivery" message
Courier companies	Regular parcels island-wide	Compare price per zone, tracking, COD handling, pick-up from your shop
Mauritius Post (Post Logistic and parcel services)	SMEs needing door-to-door parcels and pick-up from the business	Ask for current rates, delivery times and tracking options
Click and collect	Shop or partner pick-up point	Free for the customer, cheaper for you; give opening hours and a pick-up code
International shipping	Gifts to diaspora, France, Réunion	Customs, tax and food rules differ by country; start with a few products

Write a delivery promise people can trust

A good delivery promise answers five questions on the product page: **how much, how fast, where, when exactly, and what if I am not home?** For example: "*Delivery island-wide in 1–2 working days. Rs 150 in Plaines Wilhems, Rs 200 elsewhere. Free over Rs 1,500. Choose a morning or afternoon slot. Order before 12:00 for next-day delivery.*"

Returns and refunds

A clear returns policy reduces doubt, especially for fashion and electronics. Write it in plain words: which products can be returned, within how many days, in what condition, who pays the return delivery, and how fast refunds are paid (and by which method: back to card, Juice or bank transfer). Food, cosmetics and personalised items are often excluded for hygiene reasons; say so clearly.

Trust signals checklist

- ☐ Company name, BRN, physical address and opening hours in the footer and on the contact page.
- ☐ Phone number and WhatsApp button that someone actually answers.
- ☐ Real photos of your products, team and shop, not only stock images.
- ☐ Reviews with names and dates (Section 10), and a link to your Google Business Profile.
- ☐ Delivery, returns and privacy pages linked in the footer and at checkout.
- ☐ HTTPS padlock (Week 2) and a recognised payment page.
- ☐ Consistent prices and stock across website, social posts and marketplace.

SECTION 5

E-commerce KPIs and unit economics

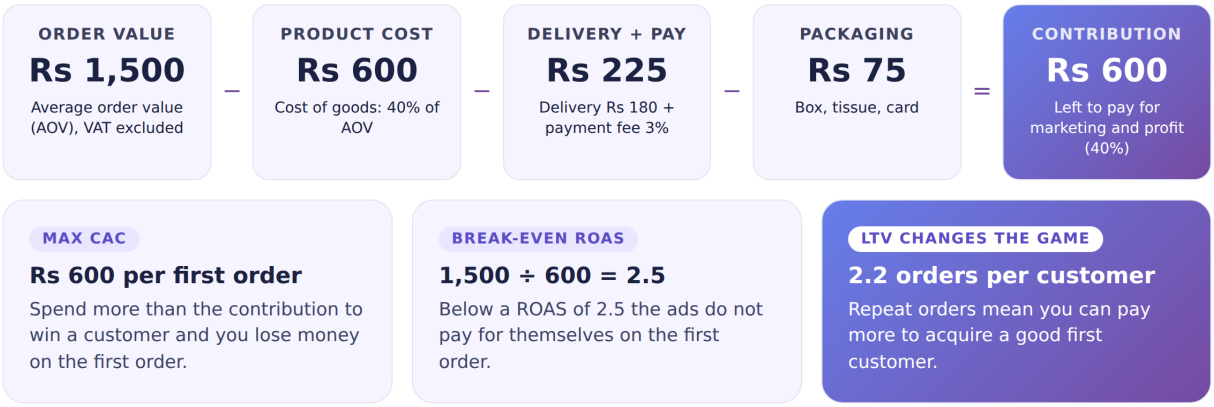
A shop can have many visitors and still lose money. Before you optimise, know the few numbers that decide whether each order is profitable and how much you can afford to pay for a customer.

The core KPIs

KPI	Formula	Example (Lakaz Zepis, one month)
Conversion rate (CVR)	Orders ÷ sessions × 100	126 orders ÷ 9,000 sessions = 1.4%
Average order value (AOV)	Revenue ÷ orders	Rs 170,100 ÷ 126 = Rs 1,350
Revenue per session	Revenue ÷ sessions (or CVR × AOV)	Rs 170,100 ÷ 9,000 = Rs 18.90
Cart abandonment rate	1 − (purchases ÷ add-to-carts)	1 − 126 ÷ 650 = 80.6%
Customer acquisition cost (CAC)	Marketing cost ÷ new customers	Rs 48,000 ÷ 80 = Rs 600
Repeat purchase rate	Customers with 2+ orders ÷ all customers	28% over 12 months
Gross margin	(Price − product cost) ÷ price	(1,350 − 540) ÷ 1,350 = 60%
Return / refund rate	Returned orders ÷ orders	2% (food); fashion is often much higher
ROAS (Week 12)	Revenue from ads ÷ ad cost	Rs 96,000 ÷ Rs 32,000 = 3.0

Unit economics: does each order make money?

Example: one Lakaz Zepis gift box order (illustrative numbers)



Contribution, break-even ROAS and maximum CAC

Contribution per order is what is left from one order after all the costs that come with it: product cost, delivery you pay, payment fees and packaging. It is the money available for marketing and profit. Three rules follow from it:

- **Maximum CAC on the first order = contribution per order.** In the example, Rs 600.
- **Break-even ROAS = AOV ÷ contribution per order** (use the same VAT basis for both). 1,500 ÷ 600 = 2.5. Below 2.5, ads lose money on the first order (Week 12 explains ROAS targets in detail).
- **Customer lifetime value (LTV)** = AOV × orders per customer × contribution margin. With 2.2 orders on average: 1,500 × 2.2 × 40% = Rs 1,320. A healthy target is LTV at least three times CAC.

Free-delivery thresholds: do the maths

"Free delivery over Rs X" is one of the strongest levers for AOV, but it costs you the delivery fee on every qualifying order. Set the threshold **a little above your current AOV** (often 15–30% above), so many customers add one more item. Then check: does the extra contribution from the larger baskets pay for the delivery you now absorb? The Excel exercise (Tab 2) walks you through this calculation.

> **Worked example.** AOV Rs 1,350, delivery costs you Rs 180. With a Rs 1,500 threshold, suppose 45% of orders now qualify and AOV rises to Rs 1,520. Extra contribution per order = (1,520 − 1,350) × 40% = Rs 68. Delivery absorbed per order = 45% × Rs 180 = Rs 81. Result: −Rs 13 per order. It only pays if conversion rate also rises (which free delivery often does) or if the threshold is set higher. Test it (Section 22).

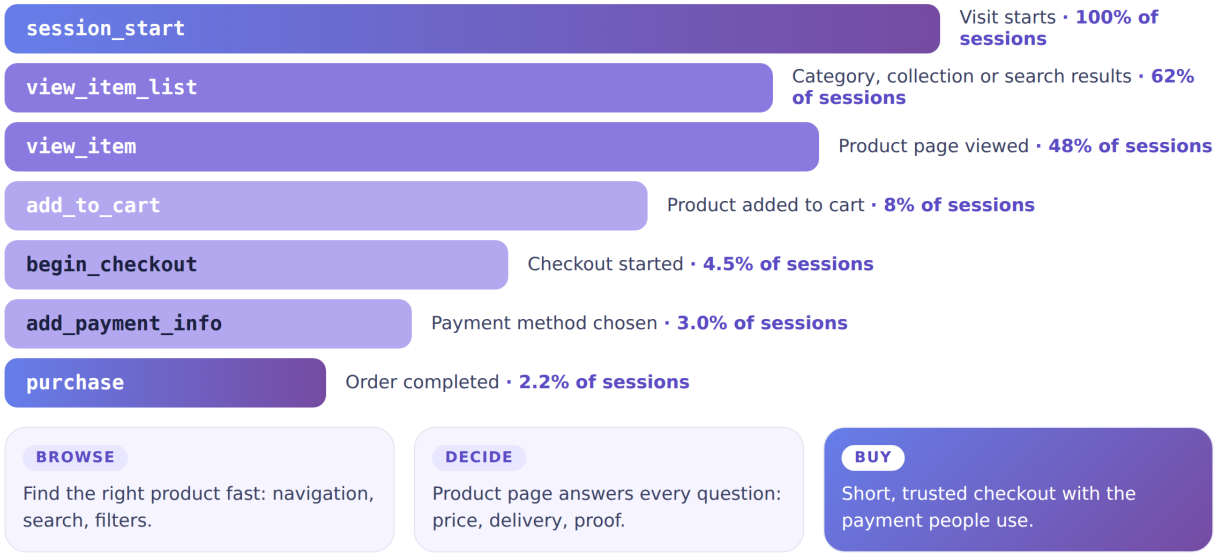
SECTION 6

The funnel and GA4 e-commerce events

To improve a shop you must see where people drop out. GA4 (Week 2 and Week 11) has a set of **recommended e-commerce events**. When they are sent correctly, GA4 builds the funnel reports for you.

The e-commerce funnel, step by step, as GA4 sees it

Each step is a recommended GA4 e-commerce event. Illustrative rates for a small Mauritian shop



The recommended events

Event	When it fires	Key parameters
view_item_list / select_item	A list of products is shown / a product in it is clicked	item_list_name, items
view_item	A product page is viewed	currency, value, items (item_id, item_name, price…)
add_to_cart / remove_from_cart	A product is added to or removed from the cart	currency, value, items
view_cart	The cart page is viewed	currency, value, items
begin_checkout	Checkout starts	currency, value, coupon, items
add_shipping_info	Delivery method or zone chosen	shipping_tier, items
add_payment_info	Payment method chosen	payment_type, items
purchase	Order completed (thank-you page)	**transaction_id**, value, currency (MUR), tax, shipping, items
refund	Order refunded	transaction_id, value
view_promotion / select_promotion	A banner or promotion is seen / clicked	promotion_name, creative_name

Where to see the funnel in GA4

- **Reports → Monetisation → E-commerce purchases:** items viewed, added to cart and purchased, item revenue. Find products with many views but few add-to-carts (a product page problem) or many add-to-carts but few purchases (a price, delivery or checkout problem).
- **Reports → Monetisation → Purchase journey:** session start → view product → add to cart → begin checkout → purchase, with drop-off at each step. Break it down by device category.
- **Reports → Monetisation → Checkout journey:** begin checkout → add shipping → add payment → purchase. It needs **add_shipping_info** and **add_payment_info**.
- **Explore → Funnel exploration** (Week 11): build your own steps, open or closed funnels, breakdowns by device, channel or new vs returning (Section 18).

What a correct purchase event looks like

If a developer sends events with Google Tag Manager (Week 11), the purchase event is pushed to the **dataLayer** on the thank-you page, like this. Your GA4 tag in GTM then reads it.

```
dataLayer.push({ ecommerce: null });   // clear the previous ecommerce object
dataLayer.push({
  event: "purchase",
  ecommerce: {
    transaction_id: "LZ-10482",      // unique order number, never reused
    value: 1250.00,                  // order value without delivery (decide once, then keep it)
    tax: 163.04, shipping: 150.00, currency: "MUR",     // VAT included in the price
    items: [{ item_id: "CEC-06", item_name: "Coffret Epices Creoles", item_category: "Gift boxes",
              price: 1250.00, quantity: 1 }]
  }
});
```

Then open GA4 **DebugView** (Admin → DebugView) and Tag Assistant, place a test order and check that every parameter arrives once, with the right currency.

Check your tracking before you trust it. Common problems: purchase sent twice when the thank-you page is reloaded (always send a unique transaction_id), currency missing, value including or excluding delivery inconsistently, and payment redirects that break the session so the sale is credited to "referral" from the payment page. Add your gateway domains to the referral exclusion list (Admin → Data streams → Configure tag settings → List unwanted referrals). Compare GA4 orders with your shop’s orders every month: a gap of more than 10–15% needs investigation.

Tip: on Shopify, the Google & YouTube app sends most e-commerce events automatically, but Google notes that **add_shipping_info** must be set up separately, so the Checkout journey report may be incomplete until you add it. On WooCommerce, use a maintained GA4 plugin or Google Tag Manager with a dataLayer (Week 11).

PART B

The shopping experience

Pages, checkout, mobile, feeds,
reviews, pricing and retention

SECTION 7

Home, category pages and search

Most visitors do not land on the product they want. They arrive on the home page, a category page or a search result and must find it in a few taps. If they cannot, they leave, and no product page can save the sale.

Navigation that matches how people shop

- Name categories in the customer’s words: "Gift boxes", "Spices", "Tea", "Hot sauces and achards", not internal codes.
- Keep the main menu to 5–7 items; add "Gifts by budget" or "Gifts by occasion" if gifting matters.
- On mobile, put search and the cart icon at the top, always visible.
- Use breadcrumbs (Home › Spices › Masala) so people can go back up a level.

Category (collection) pages

Element	Good practice
Product cards	Clear photo, name, price in Rs, rating, "new" or "best seller" label, stock warning if low
Sorting	Best sellers by default; price low to high; newest
Filters	Only the useful ones: price range, type, size, colour, dietary info, in stock
Intro text	2–3 lines at the top for customers and SEO (Week 3); more text at the bottom
Load more	"Load more" or pagination; avoid endless lists that break the back button
Quick add	For simple products, an add-to-cart button on the card saves a step

On-site search

Visitors who use search usually know what they want and often convert better. Make search forgiving: it should handle spelling mistakes, French and English words ("piment" and "chilli"), plurals and synonyms. Track it in GA4: enable **site search** in enhanced measurement and look at the search terms report (or the **view_search_results** event). Searches with no results are a free list of products to stock or synonyms to add.

> **Tip:** look at the top 20 search terms every month. If people search for "delivery", "Juice" or "return", your product pages are not answering those questions clearly.

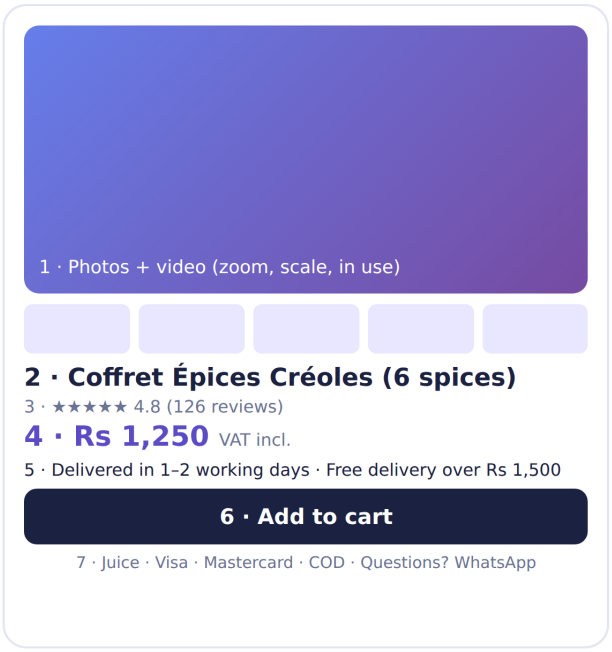
SECTION 8

The product page

The product page (often called the PDP, product detail page) is where the buying decision is made. Its job is to answer every question a shopper would ask a good salesperson, in the order they would ask it.

Anatomy of a product page that sells

Everything a buyer needs to decide, above the fold on mobile and just below it



1 · Media 5–8 sharp photos on white and in context, one short video, zoom.

2 · Clear title What it is, key variant, size or quantity.

3 · Social proof Star rating and number of reviews, linked to reviews.

4 · Price Final price in Rs, VAT included, any saving shown clearly.

5 · Delivery promise Fee, threshold, days, zones, before the cart.

6 · One main button High contrast, sticky on mobile.

7 · Reassurance Payment logos, returns, contact, BRN.

8 · Below the fold Benefits, details, size guide or ingredients, FAQ, reviews, related items.

The questions a product page must answer

Shopper's question	What to show
What is it exactly?	Clear title with type, variant and size; 1–2 line summary of the benefit
Is it good? Do others like it?	Rating, number of reviews, customer photos, "best seller" badge if true
How much, all in?	Final price in Rs with VAT, saving if on sale, delivery fee or threshold next to the price
When will I get it?	Delivery days, cut-off time, zones, pick-up option
Will it fit / suit me?	Size guide, measurements, ingredients, compatibility, how to use
Can I pay my way?	Payment logos (Juice, cards, COD) under the button
What if it goes wrong?	Returns policy summary, warranty, contact and WhatsApp
What else goes with it?	Related products, bundles, "complete the gift"

Above the fold on mobile

"Above the fold" is what people see without scrolling. On a phone this is very little space, so prioritise: main photo, title, rating, price, delivery line and the add-to-cart button. Make the button **sticky** (it stays at the bottom of the screen while scrolling) for long pages. Everything else can be lower, in clear sections or accordions (sections that open on tap).

Stock and urgency: be honest

"Only 3 left" and "order before 12:00 for delivery tomorrow" help when they are true. Fake countdown timers and invented stock levels damage trust and can mislead consumers. Use real data from your shop system.

> Never hide the price behind "DM for price" on a web shop. In Mauritius this is common on social media, but on a website it creates friction and many people simply leave.

SECTION 9

Photos, video and product copy

Online, the photo is the product. Shoppers cannot touch, smell or try anything, so your images and words must do that job.

Product photos

- **5–8 photos per product:** front on a clean background, details and texture, in use, with a hand or object for scale, packaging, and what is included.
- **Consistent style:** same background, light and framing across a category so the grid looks professional.
- **Square or 4:5 format** works well on mobile and in Meta catalogues; keep the main product centred.
- **Compress** images (WebP where possible) so pages load fast (Section 13). A phone photo of 4 MB should become 150–300 KB.
- **Alt text** describing the image for accessibility and SEO (Week 3).

Short video

A 10–30 second vertical clip showing the product in use (opening a gift box, pouring a sauce, a dress moving) answers questions photos cannot. Reuse the same clip in Reels, TikTok and catalogue ads. AI tools (Week 13) can help with editing and captions, but the product must be shown honestly.

Product copy that sells

Part	Weak	Strong
Title	Coffret 6	Coffret Épices Créoles: 6 Mauritian spices gift box
Summary	Nice spices from Mauritius.	Six hand-blended spices for curry, rougaille and briani, in a gift box ready to offer.
Benefits	High quality	Ground weekly in Curepipe, no additives, 6 recipe cards included
Details	(missing)	Weight per jar, ingredients, allergens, shelf life, box size
Objections	(missing)	"Will it arrive in time for a birthday?" → order before 12:00, next-day delivery

English, French and Kreol

If your customers read French (or you sell to Réunion and France), translate the product pages properly, not with raw machine translation. Use AI as a first draft, then have a native speaker check. Keep Kreol for social media, chat and campaign headlines, where it feels natural and personal ("Fer enn ti plezir"). Make the language switcher easy to find, and keep prices and delivery information identical in every language.

SECTION 10

Reviews, UGC and trust

Social proof means showing that other people bought and liked the product. **UGC** (user-generated content) is content made by customers: photos, videos, reviews and posts. Both reduce risk in the shopper’s mind.

Type of proof	Where to show it	How to collect it
Product reviews with stars	Product page, category cards	Email or WhatsApp 7–10 days after delivery (Section 16); review app or plugin
Customer photos and videos	Product page gallery, social, ads	Ask in the review request; reshare tagged posts with permission
Google reviews	Home page, footer, Google Business Profile	Short link to your Google review form on the delivery note
Numbers	Home page, product page	"2,000+ gift boxes delivered" (only if true)
Press and partners	Home page, About	Logos of hotels or companies you supply (with permission)

Rules for honest reviews

- Show negative reviews too, and reply politely with a solution. A 4.6 average with some critical reviews is more believable than a perfect 5.0.
- Never write fake reviews or pay for positive ones. It misleads consumers and breaks platform policies (Google and Meta remove them and can penalise the business).
- You may offer a small thank-you for **any** review (positive or negative) if you say so, but not only for positive ones.
- Display the date and first name or initials; ask permission before showing photos of people.

> **Tip:** a review request that includes a photo prompt ("Show us how you used it") collects UGC you can use on the product page and in ads. Feature one customer photo a week on Instagram to encourage more.

SECTION 11

Pricing, promotions and bundles

Price is not only a number: how you present it, combine it and promote it changes both conversion rate and average order value.

Price presentation

- Show the **final price** including VAT; show the old price crossed out only if the product was really sold at that price.
- For bigger items, show instalment or "from" prices only if your payment provider offers them.
- Show the price per unit for food and cosmetics when sizes differ (Rs per 100 g).

Promotions that do not destroy your margin

Mechanic	Good for	Watch out for
Free delivery over Rs X	Raising AOV; reducing surprise costs	Threshold too low = you pay delivery on orders that would have happened anyway (Section 5)
Bundles ("gift set of 3")	AOV, gifting, moving slower products	Price the bundle so the margin stays healthy
Gift with purchase	AOV without cutting price	Gift must be cheap to you, valuable to the customer
% discount code	Launches, win-back, newsletter sign-up	Trains people to wait for discounts; codes leak to coupon sites
Seasonal sales	Fête des Mères, Divali, Eid, Christmas, Black Friday, end of year	Plan stock and delivery capacity; announce cut-off dates
Loyalty reward	Repeat purchases	Keep it simple to understand

Cross-sell and upsell

Cross-sell suggests a complementary product ("add a jar of achards to your spice box"). **Upsell** suggests a better or bigger version ("the 12-spice box for Rs 400 more"). Show them on the product page and in the cart, with one-tap add. Keep suggestions relevant and cheap relative to the main item, usually under a third of its price.

> **In Mauritius:** the gifting calendar drives many online sales: Valentine’s Day, Fête des Mères and Fête des Pères, Divali, Eid, Christmas and New Year, plus corporate gifts at year end. Plan bundles, delivery cut-offs and landing pages 4–6 weeks ahead, and test the offer before the peak (Section 22).

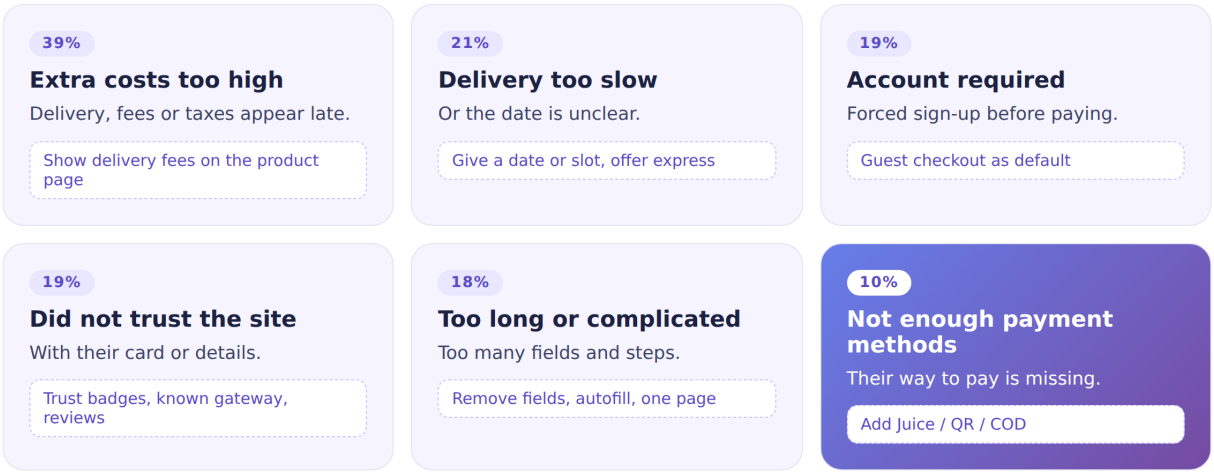
SECTION 12

Cart and checkout optimisation

The checkout is the last step, but it is where a large share of motivated buyers leave. Baymard Institute, which studies checkout usability, puts the average documented online cart abandonment rate at about **70%**. Some of that is normal (people comparing or saving for later), but a lot comes from fixable problems.

Why shoppers abandon checkout, and the fix for each

Most common reasons in Baymard Institute's large shopper surveys, with the matching fix



The cart page

- Show product photo, name, variant, quantity (easy to change), price and the running total.
- Show delivery cost (or "Free delivery: add Rs 150 more") and the estimated delivery date.
- Keep a clear "Checkout" button and a less prominent "Continue shopping" link.
- Hide or shrink the discount code field: a big empty box sends people off to search for codes.

The checkout

Fix	Why it works
Guest checkout by default; offer account creation after purchase	Forced sign-up is one of the top reasons for leaving
Ask only for what you need: name, phone, email, address, district	Every extra field costs completions; make company name and address line 2 optional
Phone number with +230 pre-filled; district drop-down	Fewer typing errors; easier delivery planning
Autofill and the right keyboard (numbers for phone)	Faster on mobile
Delivery options with prices and dates in one place	No surprises; choose slot or click and collect
Payment methods people use (Section 3), the most used first	A missing method = a lost order
Clear error messages next to the field, without clearing the form	Errors are a major cause of mobile drop-off
Order summary always visible; trust signals near the pay button	Reassurance at the moment of risk
A thank-you page with order number, next steps and WhatsApp contact	Fewer "did my order go through?" messages

> **Tip:** do a "checkout walk" every month: order a real product on your own phone, on mobile data, with each payment method. Time it and note every moment of hesitation. Then ask someone over 50 and someone who rarely shops online to do the same while you watch.

SECTION 13

Mobile commerce and speed

Most of your visitors are on a phone, often on mobile data. A shop that is slow or awkward on mobile loses sales quietly: the visitors never complain, they just leave.

Core Web Vitals in plain words

Google measures page experience with three **Core Web Vitals** (Week 2). Check them in PageSpeed Insights and the Search Console Core Web Vitals report.

Metric	What it measures	"Good" threshold	Typical e-commerce fix
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	How fast the main content, often the product photo, appears	2.5 s or less	Compress and resize images; good hosting; fewer apps
INP (Interaction to Next Paint)	How quickly the page reacts to taps	200 ms or less	Remove heavy scripts and unused apps or plugins
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	How much the page jumps while loading	0.1 or less	Set image sizes; avoid late pop-ups and banners

Mobile checklist

- ☐ Buttons at least the size of a fingertip, with space around them.
- ☐ Text readable without zooming (16 px body text); prices clear.
- ☐ Sticky add-to-cart button on long product pages.

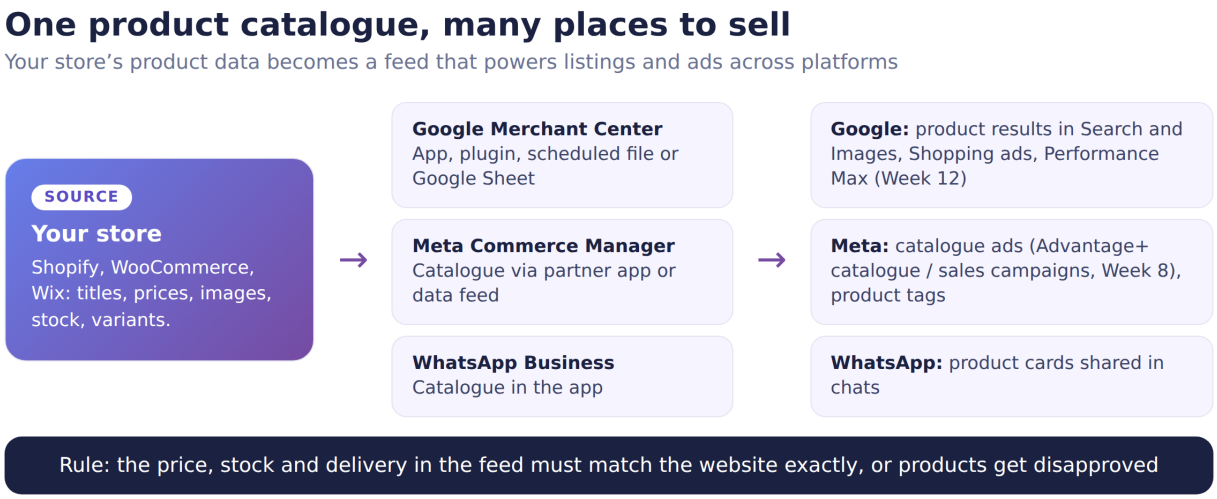
- ☐ No pop-up covering the screen on arrival; newsletter offers after some scrolling or on exit, easy to close.
- ☐ Menu, search and cart reachable with one thumb.
- ☐ Every app or plugin justified: each one adds scripts that slow the shop.
- ☐ Tested on a mid-range Android phone on mobile data, not only on the office Wi-Fi.

> **In Mauritius:** many shoppers browse on older or mid-range Android phones and on mobile data. A product page that loads in 2 seconds on your laptop may take 6–8 seconds on a bus between Port Louis and Curepipe. Test there.

SECTION 14

Product feeds and Merchant Center

A **product feed** is a file (or automatic connection) that lists every product with its attributes: ID, title, price, availability, image, link. Feeds let Google and Meta show your products in listings and ads without you building each ad by hand.



The attributes that matter most

Attribute	What it is	Tips
id	Your unique product (SKU) code	Never reuse; keep the same across Google and Meta
title	Product name (up to 150 characters)	Brand + product type + key attribute (size, colour, flavour); most important words first
description	Product description	Factual and complete; no promotional text in capitals
link / image_link	Product page URL and main image	Clean photo, no text or watermark on the main image
price / availability	Price in MUR, in stock or not	Must match the landing page exactly
brand, gtin, mpn	Brand and product identifiers	Use the barcode (GTIN) for branded goods; your own brand for products you make
shipping	Delivery cost	Set in Merchant Center settings; must match the site
product_type / custom_label	Your own categories and labels	Labels like "best seller" or "high margin" help structure campaigns

Rewrite titles for search

Before	After
Coffret 6	Lakaz Zepis Creole Spice Gift Box – 6 Mauritian Spices with Recipe Cards
Thé vanille 100g	Lakaz Zepis Vanilla Black Tea, Loose Leaf, 100 g – Mauritius
Piment fort	Lakaz Zepis Hot Chilli Sauce (Piment Fort) 250 ml – Mauritian Recipe

Google Merchant Center in Mauritius

Google Merchant Center is the free tool where you upload products for Google. Mauritius appears in Google's list of supported countries for Merchant Center, with the Mauritian rupee (MUR) as currency. However, Google's help page notes that the dedicated **Shopping tab is not available to users in Mauritius**, so local shoppers mainly see products in normal Search results, Images and other Google surfaces, and through Shopping or Performance Max campaigns (Week 12). Availability of each programme can change and can differ by account: check the status of your products under **Products** and the programmes shown in your own Merchant Center.

Getting set up

1. Create a Merchant Center account with the business email and verify and claim your website.
2. Add business information, delivery (shipping) and returns settings that match your site.
3. Connect your products: the Google & YouTube app on Shopify, a feed plugin on WooCommerce, or a Google Sheet for small catalogues.
4. Fix errors and warnings in the diagnostics (price mismatch, missing GTIN, image problems).
5. Link Merchant Center to Google Ads to use the feed in Shopping or Performance Max campaigns (Week 12).

> **Tip:** if feed-based Google campaigns are not an option for you, the same work still pays off: clean titles, images and prices improve your own site, your Meta catalogue and your organic visibility. Search campaigns pointing to strong product or category pages (Weeks 6–7) remain a solid alternative.

SECTION 15

Meta and WhatsApp catalogues

On Facebook and Instagram, a **catalogue** holds your products for ads and shopping features. You saw catalogue ads and Advantage+ sales campaigns in Week 8. Here we focus on keeping the catalogue clean, because the ads are only as good as the data behind them.

Task	How
Create the catalogue	Meta Commerce Manager → add catalogue (e-commerce); connect via the Shopify or WooCommerce partner integration, or a scheduled data feed
Connect the Pixel and Conversions API	So that view_content, add_to_cart and purchase events match product IDs (Week 8)
Create product sets	Best sellers, gift boxes, under Rs 1,000, new arrivals; use them in ads
Check diagnostics	Rejected items, missing images, price mismatch, low-quality photos
Use catalogue ads	Retarget people who viewed or added to cart; prospect with broad audiences

WhatsApp Business catalogue

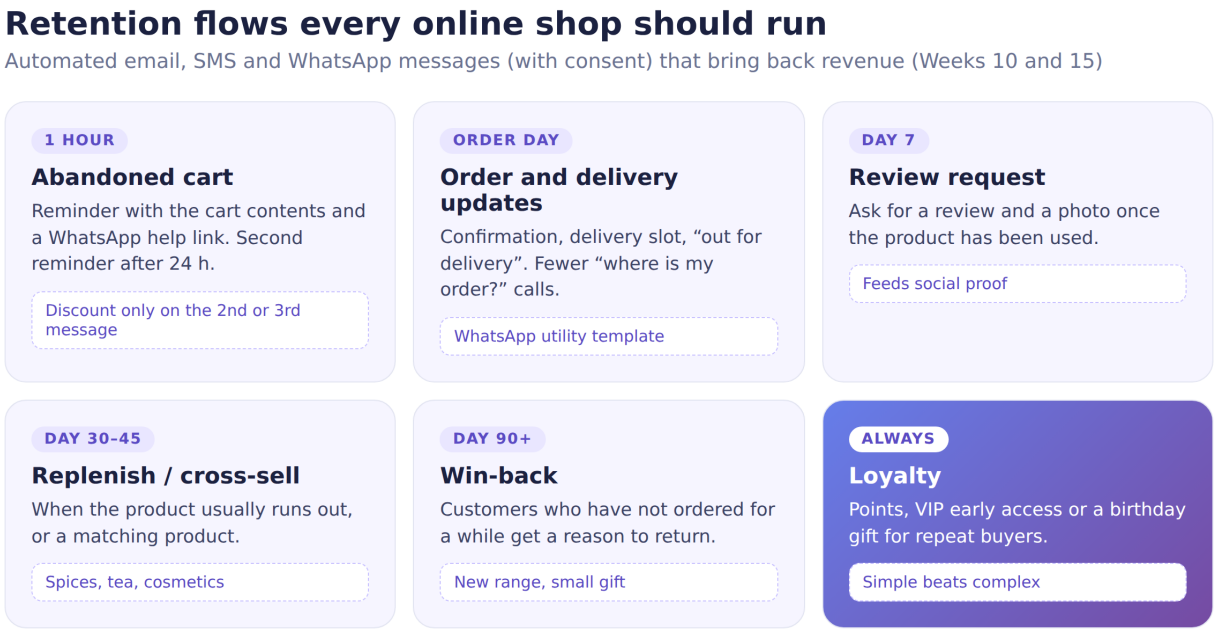
The WhatsApp Business app lets you show a catalogue inside chats: product name, photo, price, description and a link. It is ideal for the many Mauritian customers who prefer to order by WhatsApp. Keep it in sync with your website (at least your top 20–30 products), and send product cards instead of long text messages. For bigger volumes, the WhatsApp Business Platform with a provider allows automated order updates (Week 15).

> **Tip:** add the product link (with UTM parameters, Week 2) to catalogue items so that WhatsApp sales from the website can be tracked in GA4 instead of disappearing into "direct".

SECTION 16

Retention: flows and loyalty

Winning a new customer usually costs much more than selling again to an existing one. In a small market like Mauritius, repeat customers are the difference between a shop that struggles and one that grows. Week 10 covered email and CRM, Week 15 automation; here is how they apply to an online shop.



Abandoned cart and browse flows

An **abandoned cart flow** sends a reminder to someone who added to cart, left their email or phone, and did not buy. Shopify, WooCommerce plugins and email tools (Mailchimp, Klaviyo, Brevo, Omnisend) all offer it. A typical sequence: reminder after 1 hour with the cart contents and a help link; second message after 24 hours with reviews or answers to common doubts; a small incentive only in a third message, if at all. Only contact people who gave consent for marketing messages (Section 25).

Measure retention

Metric	How to read it
Repeat purchase rate	% of customers who ordered twice or more in 12 months
Time between orders	Median days between first and second order: the right moment for a reminder
Revenue from flows	Revenue attributed to automated emails and messages per month
Cohort retention	Of customers acquired in March, how many bought again in the next months (Week 11)

Loyalty without complexity

A points app is not always needed. Many small shops do well with simple rules: a thank-you note in the box, a "second order" code, early access to new products for past customers, a birthday message, and great service when something goes wrong. Make sure customers can subscribe to WhatsApp or email updates at checkout with a clear, unticked opt-in box.

PART C

Conversion rate optimisation

Research, hypotheses, prioritisation,
A/B testing and the statistics behind it

SECTION 17

The CRO method

Conversion rate optimisation (CRO) is the structured process of increasing the share of visitors who do what you want (buy, add to cart, sign up), by understanding why they do not and testing changes. Good CRO is not "change the button colour". It is research first, then focused tests.

The CRO cycle

Conversion rate optimisation is a loop of evidence, not a list of random changes



Step	Key question	Tools and outputs
1 Research	Where do we lose people, and why?	GA4 funnels (Section 18), Clarity heatmaps and recordings, surveys, user tests, customer messages (Section 19) → list of problems
2 Hypothesise	What change could fix it, for whom, and how will we know?	Hypothesis statements (Section 20)
3 Prioritise	What should we do first?	ICE or PIE scores (Section 21) → a test roadmap
4 Test	Does the change really work?	A/B test or controlled before/after (Sections 22–23)
5 Learn	What did we learn, and what next?	Analysis, decision, test log, next hypotheses (Section 24)

Fix, test or investigate?

Not everything needs an A/B test. Sort every finding into one of three buckets:

- **Just fix it:** obvious bugs and gaps. A broken button on Android, a missing delivery fee, a Juice payment that fails, a 6 MB image. Fix and monitor.
- **Test it:** changes where the effect is uncertain and the traffic allows a test. New product page layout, free-delivery threshold, checkout in one page vs several steps.
- **Investigate:** problems you can see but not yet explain. Run recordings, a survey or user tests first.

> **Remember the maths:** a shop with 9,000 sessions, 1.4% conversion and Rs 1,350 AOV earns about Rs 170,100 a month. Moving conversion to 1.7% (+0.3 points) adds about Rs 36,500 a month with the **same** ad budget. That is why CRO is often the cheapest growth lever.

SECTION 18

Quantitative research with GA4

Quantitative research uses numbers to show **where** the problems are and how big they are. Start in GA4 with the funnel, then break it down.

Build a funnel exploration

1. Go to **Explore → Funnel exploration**.
2. Steps: session_start → view_item → add_to_cart → begin_checkout → add_payment_info → purchase.
3. Choose an **open funnel** (users can enter at any step) to see where people really enter, or a closed one to follow a strict path.
4. Add a breakdown by **Device category**, then by **Session default channel group** and **New / returning**.
5. Turn on **Show elapsed time** and look at **Next action** after the biggest drop.

Size the opportunity in rupees

Compare segments: if desktop converts from begin_checkout to purchase at 62% and mobile at 41%, the gap tells you where to look. Then estimate the value of closing part of it:

Calculation	Example
Mobile users who began checkout	640
Mobile checkout completion rate vs desktop	41% vs 62% → gap of 21 points
If mobile reached half the gap (+10.5 points)	640 × 10.5% = 67 extra orders
Value per month	67 × Rs 1,350 AOV = about Rs 90,500

Other useful reports

- **E-commerce purchases** by item: view-to-cart rate per product. Products with high views and low adds need better pages or prices.
- **Landing page** report with engagement rate and key events: weak landing pages for ad traffic.
- **Pages and screens** filtered on checkout URLs, and the **view_search_results** event.
- **Speed** data from PageSpeed Insights and Search Console for your top product templates.

> **Tip:** write each finding as a fact with a number: "Mobile add-to-cart rate is 6.2% vs 9.8% on desktop on gift box pages (last 30 days)". Vague findings ("mobile is bad") lead to vague tests.

SECTION 19

Qualitative research: Clarity and users

Numbers show where people leave; qualitative research shows **why**. The fastest free tool for this is **Microsoft Clarity**, a free behaviour analytics tool with no traffic limit.

What Clarity gives you

Feature	What it shows	How to use it
Heatmaps	Where people click and how far they scroll, by device	Do people reach the delivery info and reviews? Do they tap images that are not clickable?
Session recordings	Anonymised replays of real visits	Watch 20–30 recordings of mobile users who reached checkout but did not buy
Rage clicks / dead clicks	Repeated taps on one spot; taps that do nothing	Find broken buttons, confusing elements, non-clickable images
Quick backs and excessive scrolling	People leaving a page immediately or searching on it	Spot misleading links and pages that do not answer questions
Filters and segments	Recordings by device, page, country, traffic source, custom tags	Focus on the funnel step you are investigating
Copilot (AI) summaries	AI summaries of sessions and heatmaps	A starting point; always watch some recordings yourself

Set-up in 15 minutes

1. Create a free project at clarity.microsoft.com with your business account.
2. Install the tag: Shopify and WordPress have official integrations, or use Google Tag Manager.
3. Check that sensitive fields (address, phone, payment) are masked; Clarity masks input fields by default, keep it that way.
4. Connect Clarity to GA4 if you want to jump from GA4 segments to recordings.
5. Add Clarity to your cookie banner and privacy policy (Section 25). For visitors from the EEA, UK and Switzerland, Microsoft has required a consent signal since 31 October 2025, otherwise data for those visitors is limited.

Talk to customers

Method	How	What you learn
Exit or post-purchase survey	One question: "What almost stopped you from buying today?" or "What is missing on this page?"	Objections in the customer’s own words
Customer messages	Read 50 recent WhatsApp, Messenger and email questions; tag them by theme	Missing information on pages
5-person user test	Ask 5 people to buy a gift under Rs 1,500 on their phone while thinking aloud	Usability problems; five users usually reveal the main ones
Review mining	Read your and competitors’ reviews for praise and complaints	Benefits to highlight, fears to answer

SECTION 20

Writing strong hypotheses

A **hypothesis** is a testable statement that links evidence, a change and an expected result. It turns "I think we should..." into something you can prove right or wrong.

How to write a test hypothesis

Evidence → change → audience → expected effect → metric. If you cannot fill every box, it is a guess, not a hypothesis

BECAUSE	WE BELIEVE	FOR	WILL CAUSE	MEASURED BY
We saw...	**Changing...**	**Audience...**	**Effect...**	**Metric...**
62% of mobile users leave the cart; Clarity shows them scrolling to find delivery fees.	showing the delivery fee and free-delivery threshold on product pages	mobile visitors on product pages	more people to start checkout because there is no surprise cost	Primary: purchase rate per session. Guardrail: AOV.

“Because we saw that 62% of mobile users leave the cart and recordings show them looking for the delivery fee, we believe that showing the fee and the Rs 1,500 free-delivery threshold on product pages for mobile visitors will increase the purchase rate per session. We will also watch AOV.”

Good and weak hypotheses

Weak	Why it is weak	Strong version
"Let’s test a red button."	No evidence, no reason, no metric	"Because Clarity shows 38% of mobile visitors never scroll to the add-to-cart button on gift box pages, we believe a sticky add-to-cart bar for mobile will increase add-to-cart rate. Guardrail: purchase rate."
"A new homepage will increase sales."	Too broad; homepage is not where people drop	"Because 55% of search ad visitors land on the home page and leave, we believe sending them to the matching category page will raise purchase rate per session for paid search traffic."
"Discounts will help."	No mechanism; margin risk	"Because surveys show delivery cost is the top objection, we believe free delivery over Rs 1,500 (vs Rs 2,000) will raise purchase rate while keeping contribution per session at least equal."

Choose the right metric

- **Primary metric:** the one that decides the test. For most shop tests: purchase rate per visitor or per session, or revenue per visitor. For upper-funnel tests: add-to-cart rate, but confirm it does not hurt purchases.
- **Guardrail metrics:** things that must not get worse: AOV, refund rate, page speed, contribution margin.
- **Revenue per visitor (RPV)** combines conversion and order value; it is the best single metric for price and delivery tests, but it is noisier, so it needs more traffic.

Tip: write the hypothesis and the metric **before** the test starts and save it in your test log. Deciding afterwards which metric "counts" is one of the most common ways to fool yourself.

SECTION 21

Prioritising tests: ICE and PIE

After research you will have 20–40 ideas. You can test only a few at a time, so you need a simple, shared way to decide the order.

Prioritise with ICE: Impact, Confidence, Ease

Score each idea 1–10 on each factor, then average. Test the highest scores first

Idea	I	C	E	ICE
Show delivery fee on product page	8	9	9	**8.7**
Guest checkout by default	9	7	6	**7.3**
Add Juice at checkout	7	8	5	**6.7**
New homepage banner	3	4	9	**5.3**
Product video on top 10 items	6	5	4	**5.0**

Impact: how much could it move the key metric, on how many visitors?

Confidence: how strong is the evidence (data, recordings, research)?

Ease: how quick and cheap is it to build and test?

PIE is a similar model: Potential, Importance, Ease

ICE scoring

Factor	Question	Scoring guide (1–10)
Impact	If it works, how much will it move the primary metric?	8–10: affects a high-traffic step with a large problem; 1–3: small page or small change
Confidence	How sure are we that it will work?	8–10: several sources agree (GA4 + recordings + survey); 1–3: a hunch
Ease	How easy is it to build and test?	8–10: a setting or text change; 1–3: developer work, new app, legal checks

ICE score = (Impact + Confidence + Ease) ÷ 3. Some teams multiply instead of averaging; either works if the whole team uses the same rule. Sort by score and test from the top, but keep a mix: one quick win and one bigger idea at a time.

PIE as an alternative

PIE scores **P**otential (how much room for improvement the page has), **I**mportance (how valuable its traffic is, e.g. high-spend landing pages) and **E**ase. It is useful for choosing **which pages** to work on; ICE is handy for choosing **which ideas** to test. The Excel exercise (Tab 4) uses ICE.

> Scores are subjective. Agree the scoring guide first, score separately, then discuss the differences. If one person scores everything 9, the method stops working.

SECTION 22

A/B testing: tools and set-up

An **A/B test** shows two versions of a page at the same time to randomly split visitors: A (control, the current version) and B (the variant). Because both run in the same period, differences in season, ads or weather affect both equally.

Tools in 2026

Google Optimize, the free tool many tutorials still mention, was **shut down in September 2023**. Today's options:

Tool type	Examples	Good to know
Dedicated testing platforms	VWO, Optimizely, AB Tasty, Convert	Visual editor, targeting, statistics, GA4 integration; paid plans, trials available
Open-source / product analytics	GrowthBook, PostHog	Free tiers or self-hosting; more technical set-up
Shopify native	Shopify Rollouts (announced in the Winter '26 Edition)	Schedules theme changes and can split traffic between theme versions; early access, limited targeting
Shopify apps	Apps for theme, price and delivery tests	Check reviews, statistics method and effect on speed
Ad platform experiments	Google Ads experiments, Meta A/B tests	For ads and landing pages from ads (Weeks 7–8), not the whole site

Set-up checklist

- ☐ Hypothesis, primary metric and guardrails written in the test log.
- ☐ Sample size and duration calculated in advance (Section 23).
- ☐ Only one main change per test (or a clearly defined "bundle" of changes for a bold redesign).
- ☐ Variant checked on iPhone, Android, desktop, in English and French; no flicker (the original showing for a moment before the variant).
- ☐ Tracking checked: each visitor has a variant label that reaches GA4 (an event parameter or custom dimension, Week 11).
- ☐ Traffic split 50/50; no campaign or price change planned that affects only one version.
- ☐ Start date, planned end date and decision rule agreed by the team.

Implementing a test, step by step

Example: test T2 from the case study (Section 26), a new mobile product page layout, on a Shopify shop with a testing tool.

Step	What to do	Who
1 Brief	Write the test plan (Section 29) and a mock-up of the variant; agree it with the owner	Marketer
2 Build	Create the variant in the testing tool's visual editor, or duplicate the theme and edit the product template	Marketer or developer
3 Target	Audience: mobile visitors to product pages; split 50/50; exclude staff IP addresses if possible	Marketer
4 Track	Primary metric (add_to_cart) and guardrail (purchase) set in the tool; variant label sent to GA4 as an event parameter	Marketer / analyst

Step	What to do	Who
5 QA	Preview both versions on iPhone and Android, EN and FR; check speed, flicker, add to cart, checkout and the GA4 events in DebugView	Two people
6 Launch	Start on a Monday; note the date in the test log; no other changes to these pages during the test	Marketer
7 Monitor	Check daily only for bugs and the 50/50 split, not for the result	Marketer
8 Decide	At the planned end date, read the result (Section 24), decide, record, and roll out or remove the variant	Team

When you do not have enough traffic

Many Mauritian shops have a few thousand sessions a month: too few for classic A/B tests on purchases. Options: test **bold** changes (bigger expected effects need fewer visitors), test on a **higher-traffic metric** such as add-to-cart, run tests in **Google or Meta ads** where traffic is easier to buy, or make a **controlled before/after change**: implement it, compare 4 weeks before vs 4 weeks after with the same promotions and similar traffic, and treat the result as a strong hint, not proof.

SECTION 23

Statistics basics: sample size and significance

You do not need to be a statistician, but you need three ideas to avoid false winners: sample size, statistical significance and test duration.

How many visitors does an A/B test need?

Visitors per version, with a 2% baseline conversion rate, 95% confidence and 80% power (rule of thumb $n \approx 16 \times p \times (1 - p) \div d^2$)



Small changes need huge traffic
Most Mauritian shops cannot detect a +10% effect on purchases. Test bold changes.

Run full weeks
At least 2 full weeks (7-day cycles), and decide the sample size before you start.

Don’t peek and stop
Stopping when the result first looks good gives false winners.

1. Sample size: decide before you start

A simple rule of thumb for each version, with 95% confidence and 80% power (the chance of detecting a real effect of that size): **$n \approx 16 \times p \times (1 - p) \div d^2$**, where **p** is your current conversion rate and **d** the absolute change you want to detect. Example: p = 2% and you want to detect 2.0% → 2.5% (d = 0.5 points): $16 \times 0.02 \times 0.98 \div 0.005^2 \approx$ **12,500 visitors per version**. Testing tools and free online calculators do this for you; the point is to know the order of magnitude.

2. Statistical significance in plain words

If B converts better than A in your sample, it could be real or just luck. **Statistical significance** tells you how unlikely the difference would be if there were really no difference. "Significant at 95%" (p-value below 0.05) means: if A and B were truly the same, a difference this large would happen less than 5% of the time by chance. Many tools use a two-proportion **z-test**:

```
pooled rate  p  = (orders A + orders B) / (visitors A + visitors B)
standard error SE = SQRT( p * (1 - p) * (1/visitors A + 1/visitors B) )
z = (rate B - rate A) / SE
|z| >= 1.96  ->  significant at 95% (two-sided)
p-value in Excel: =2*(1-NORM.S.DIST(ABS(z),TRUE))
```

Some tools (VWO, for example) use **Bayesian** statistics and report a "probability to be best" instead. That is fine: just set your decision rule (e.g. 95%) in advance.

3. Duration

Duration (days) = total visitors needed ÷ daily visitors in the test. Always run **whole weeks** (at least 2) so weekdays and weekends are both included, and avoid mixing a normal week with a big sale or a public holiday rush. Example: 25,000 visitors needed, 900 test visitors a day → 28 days = 4 weeks.

Five mistakes that create false winners

1. **Peeking:** checking every day and stopping as soon as B looks significant.
2. **Too small samples:** "B won 12 orders to 8" is not evidence.
3. **Too many variants or metrics:** with 10 metrics, one will look significant by chance.
4. **Sample ratio mismatch:** a 50/50 split that ends at 46/54 signals a technical problem; check before reading results.
5. **Novelty effect:** returning visitors click on anything new for a few days; let the test run.

SECTION 24

Analysing results and personalisation

A test is only useful if it leads to a clear decision and a recorded lesson. Losing tests are not failures: they stop you from making a change that would have cost money.

Reading the result

Outcome	What it means	Decision
B wins, significant, guardrails OK	The change works	Implement for everyone; monitor for 4 weeks
B wins on primary, guardrail worse (e.g. AOV down)	Trade-off	Calculate revenue or contribution per visitor; decide on profit, not only conversion
No significant difference	Effect too small to detect, or none	Keep the simpler or cheaper version; try a bolder idea
B loses, significant	The change hurts	Keep A; record why the hypothesis was wrong
Mixed by segment (wins on mobile, loses on desktop)	Possible real difference, or chance	Re-test on the segment only before personalising

Calculate uplift

Relative uplift = (rate B − rate A) ÷ rate A. Example: A converts 1.80%, B 2.16% → uplift = 0.36 ÷ 1.80 = **+20%**. The **absolute** difference is 0.36 percentage points. Always state which one you mean.

Keep a test log

For each test: ID, page, hypothesis, dates, visitors and conversions per version, uplift, significance, decision, screenshots and what you learned. After a year, this log is one of the most valuable documents your business owns.

Personalisation

Personalisation means showing different content to different visitors. Start simple and rule-based, using data you already have:

- **Language:** French or English version based on the visitor’s choice (not only browser settings).
- **Location:** a delivery message for Mauritius vs "we ship to Réunion and France" for visitors abroad.
- **New vs returning:** a welcome offer for first visits; "welcome back" and recently viewed items for returning ones.
- **Source:** landing page headline that matches the ad or email campaign (message match, Week 7).
- **Behaviour:** product recommendations based on views and purchases (many platforms offer AI recommendations).

> Personalisation multiplies the versions you must maintain and test. Use it when a segment is big and clearly different. Personalising on sensitive data (health, religion, ethnicity) is risky and needs a strong legal basis under the Data Protection Act; avoid it.

PART D

Plan and practise

Legal basics, a 90-day case study, FAQ,
your E-Commerce Growth Plan and templates

SECTION 25

Legal and compliance basics

Selling online means handling money, personal data and promises to consumers. This section is a practical overview, not legal advice: for your terms and policies, check the current laws and ask a professional when in doubt.

Area	What applies	What to do on your shop
Personal data	**Data Protection Act 2017** (Mauritius), supervised by the Data Protection Office; GDPR if you target customers in the EU	Privacy notice, collect only what you need, secure access to orders, consent for marketing, check whether you must register as a controller with the Data Protection Office
Cookies and tracking	Consent rules for GA4, Meta Pixel, Clarity and similar tools	Cookie banner with real choice, Google Consent Mode (Week 11), Clarity consent signal for EEA/UK/CH visitors
Marketing messages	Consent for email, SMS and WhatsApp marketing (Week 10)	Unticked opt-in box at checkout, unsubscribe in every message, keep proof of consent
Consumer protection and prices	Mauritian consumer protection laws (including price display rules and the ban on misleading claims)	Show final prices in Rs with VAT, honest "was" prices and stock claims, clear product information
Online contracts	Electronic Transactions Act (electronic contracts and records)	Terms and conditions accepted at checkout, order confirmation by email or WhatsApp
Returns and refunds	No dedicated Mauritian distance-selling law with a cooling-off period yet; the government announced in 2025 that it intends to regulate e-commerce. EU rules (14-day withdrawal) can apply if you sell to EU consumers	Write a clear, fair returns policy anyway; it is a trust and conversion tool
Business identity	Registered business, BRN, VAT if registered	Company name, BRN, address and contact on the site and invoices

Must-have pages

- ☐ Terms and conditions of sale (prices, payment, delivery, cancellations, liability).
- ☐ Delivery policy (zones, fees, times, failed deliveries).
- ☐ Returns and refunds policy.
- ☐ Privacy policy (what data, why, how long, who it is shared with: payment gateway, couriers, email tool; how to exercise rights).
- ☐ Cookie policy and banner.
- ☐ Contact page with BRN, address, phone and WhatsApp.

> A/B tests must not mislead. Testing two layouts is fine; showing two different prices for the same product to different people without a clear reason (and without being able to honour the lower price) creates legal and trust risks. Test delivery thresholds, bundles and offers openly instead.

SECTION 26

Case study: Lakaz Zepis, 90 days

"Lakaz Zepis" is a fictional online shop in Curepipe selling Mauritian spice blends, teas, hot sauces, achards and gift boxes. It runs on Shopify, gets about 9,000 sessions a month (72% on mobile) from Instagram, Facebook ads, Google and WhatsApp, and delivers island-wide. The numbers below are illustrative.

Starting point (month 0)

KPI	Value	Comment
Sessions per month	9,000	72% mobile
Conversion rate	1.4% (126 orders)	Desktop 2.6%, mobile 0.95%
AOV	Rs 1,350	Gift boxes Rs 1,250–2,400
Revenue	Rs 170,100	+ about 40 orders a month by WhatsApp, not tracked
Cart abandonment	80.6%	Above the ~70% benchmark
Ad spend	Rs 32,000	Meta 70%, Google Search 30%



Days 1–30: measure and fix

Tracking audit: GA4 showed 18% fewer purchases than Shopify. Causes: no add_shipping_info event, and the payment gateway appeared as a referral source. Fixes: referral exclusion for the gateway domain, add_shipping_info added, monthly reconciliation set up. **Research:** funnel exploration by device, 60 Clarity recordings of mobile checkouts, a one-question post-purchase survey, and 80 WhatsApp questions tagged by theme.

Finding (evidence)	Action
Top WhatsApp question: "How much is delivery?" (31%)	Just fix: delivery fee and threshold line on every product page
Recordings: account creation required; 14 rage clicks on the "Create account" step	Just fix: guest checkout by default
Survey: "I wanted to pay with Juice" (22% of answers)	Just fix: gateway with Juice added and shown on product pages
Mobile product pages: LCP 5.8 s, photos 2–4 MB	Just fix: images compressed; two unused apps removed; LCP 2.4 s

Finding (evidence)	Action
Mobile users rarely scroll to reviews or the add-to-cart button on long pages	Test: new mobile product page layout (T2)
Free delivery threshold Rs 2,000 seen as too high in survey	Test: Rs 1,500 vs Rs 2,000 (T1)

Days 31–60: two A/B tests

Test	Visitors A / B	Result A / B	Uplift, z	Decision
T1 Free delivery Rs 1,500 (B) vs Rs 2,000 (A); metric: purchase rate, guardrail contribution per visitor	5,200 / 5,150	73 orders 1.40% / 92 orders 1.79%	+27%, z = 1.55 (not significant at 95%)	Adopted B: contribution per visitor higher and low risk; monitored for 4 weeks
T2 Mobile product page: sticky add-to-cart, delivery line under price, reviews higher (B); metric: add-to-cart rate	4,100 / 4,080	250 adds 6.10% / 310 adds 7.60%	+25%, z = 2.69 (significant)	Implemented for all mobile visitors

Lesson from T1: the result was promising but not statistically significant. The team did not pretend it was a proven win; they adopted it because the downside was small and the contribution per visitor was better, and they kept watching. That is an honest business decision.

Days 61–90: scale and retain

- Gift bundles for the year-end season, with a "complete the gift" cross-sell in the cart.
- Abandoned cart flow (email + WhatsApp for opted-in customers) and review request on day 7.
- Merchant Center feed cleaned (titles rewritten, GTINs for branded items, prices synced) and Meta catalogue product sets for catalogue ads.
- WhatsApp orders logged in Shopify as draft orders, so they appear in sales reports.

Results after 90 days

KPI	Month 0	Month 3	Change
Sessions	9,000	9,500	+6%
Conversion rate	1.4%	2.0%	+0.6 points
AOV	Rs 1,350	Rs 1,420	+5%
Revenue (website)	Rs 170,100	Rs 269,800	+59%
Ad spend	Rs 32,000	Rs 32,000	Same budget
Revenue from flows	Rs 0	Rs 21,500	New

What made the difference: fixing tracking first, answering the questions customers kept asking (delivery and Juice), making the mobile product page easier, and testing the two uncertain ideas instead of debating them. Ad spend did not change: the same visitors simply bought more often.

SECTION 27

Frequently asked questions

Should I start with a website or just sell on Instagram and WhatsApp?

Start where your customers are, but plan the website early. Once you have more than a few orders a day, a shop saves time, gives you data and builds trust. Keep WhatsApp as the help and order channel next to it.

Shopify or WooCommerce?

Shopify if you want to launch quickly without managing hosting and updates; WooCommerce if you already run WordPress or need full control. Decide after checking which local payment gateway works with each (Section 3).

Can I use Stripe or Shopify Payments?

Not with a Mauritius-based business at the time of writing. Use a local gateway (for example MIPS, Peach Payments or a bank gateway) and check which wallets and QR payments it includes.

Is Google Shopping available in Mauritius?

Mauritius is listed in Merchant Center's supported countries (MUR), but Google says the Shopping tab is not shown to users in Mauritius. Check what your own account allows; a clean feed is useful for Meta catalogues and Performance Max anyway (Section 14).

What is a good conversion rate?

It depends heavily on the product, price, traffic source and device. Compare yourself with your own past results and between segments (mobile vs desktop, channel vs channel), not with a global average.

How many visitors do I need for an A/B test?

Usually thousands per version. Use the rule of thumb in Section 23 or a calculator before starting. With low traffic, test bold changes, test on add-to-cart, or use careful before/after comparisons.

Should I offer cash on delivery?

It helps first-time buyers trust you. Limit the risk: confirm orders by message before dispatch, set a maximum order value for COD and encourage prepayment (for example a small discount or faster delivery).

Do discounts increase conversion?

Usually yes in the short term, but they cut margin and train customers to wait. Try free-delivery thresholds, bundles or gifts first, and calculate contribution per order (Section 5).

Is Microsoft Clarity legal to use?

Yes, with transparency: mention it in your privacy and cookie notices, keep sensitive fields masked, and send a consent signal for visitors from the EEA, UK and Switzerland.

How often should I run tests?

Aim for one or two tests running at all times if traffic allows, with a monthly review of results and a refreshed ICE list. Consistency beats occasional big redesigns.

SECTION 28

Exercises and capstone

Use your own shop, a client’s shop, or a local online shop you know well (analysing public pages only). Each exercise builds part of your final deliverable.

Exercise 16.1: Product page and checkout audit

Pick three key product pages (best seller, high-value item, item with low sales) and the checkout. Score each product page with the 20-point audit scorecard (Section 29), on mobile. Do a "checkout walk" with a test order up to the payment step and note every friction point with a screenshot. Finish with your top 10 issues, each labelled "just fix", "test" or "investigate".

Exercise 16.2: Funnel analysis and A/B test plan

In your shop’s GA4 (or the GA4 demo account of the Google Merchandise Store), build a funnel exploration from view_item to purchase broken down by device. Install Microsoft Clarity (or, without site access, use the funnel data and a 5-person user test) and watch at least 20 recordings. Write three findings with numbers, then turn the best one into a full A/B test plan: hypothesis, variant description, primary and guardrail metrics, sample size, duration and decision rule.

Exercise 16.3 (deliverable): E-Commerce Growth Plan

Write a 6–10 page E-Commerce CRO plan using this structure:

#	Part	What to include
1	Business snapshot	Products, platform, channels, payment and delivery set-up
2	Baseline KPIs and unit economics	Sessions, CVR by device, AOV, revenue, cart abandonment, contribution per order, break-even ROAS, max CAC
3	Tracking check	GA4 e-commerce events present and correct; GA4 vs shop orders; fixes needed
4	Research findings	Funnel analysis, Clarity insights, customer questions or survey, page audits: 6–10 findings with evidence
5	Quick fixes	Items to "just fix", owner and date
6	5 hypothesis-driven tests	For each: hypothesis (because / we believe / for / will cause / measured by), variant, metric and guardrail, ICE score, sample size and duration, decision rule
7	Prioritised roadmap	90-day calendar of fixes and tests
8	Implementation guide	For each test: tool, set-up steps, QA checklist, tracking, who does what, how results are documented
9	Retention and feeds	Abandoned cart and post-purchase flows, catalogue and feed improvements
10	Risks and compliance	Consent, data protection, honest pricing and claims

Exercise 16.4: E-commerce and CRO in Excel

Complete the five tabs of the Excel workbook: funnel by device with lost revenue, unit economics and the free-delivery threshold, A/B test analysis with a z-score, ICE prioritisation and a product page audit score. Keep your formulas in the cells.

> **Tip:** the strongest plans are specific: real numbers, screenshots, named pages and a calendar. "Improve the checkout" is not a test; "guest checkout by default on mobile, measured by checkout completion rate, 4 weeks from 3 November" is.

SECTION 29

Worksheets and templates

Copy these into a Google Doc or Sheet and fill them in for your shop.

Product page audit scorecard (20 points)

Score each line 0 (missing), 1 (partly) or 2 (good) on a phone.

#	Criterion	Score
1	Clear title with type, variant and size	0 / 1 / 2
2	5+ quality photos, zoom, in-use and scale photos; video if useful	0 / 1 / 2
3	Price in Rs with VAT, visible without scrolling	0 / 1 / 2
4	Delivery fee, threshold and timing near the price	0 / 1 / 2
5	Add-to-cart button visible, high contrast, sticky on mobile	0 / 1 / 2
6	Reviews and rating with number of reviews	0 / 1 / 2
7	Benefits and full details (size guide, ingredients, specs)	0 / 1 / 2
8	Payment logos and returns summary near the button	0 / 1 / 2
9	WhatsApp or chat help, contact details	0 / 1 / 2
10	Loads fast on mobile data (LCP 2.5 s or less)	0 / 1 / 2

Test plan template

Field	Your test
Test ID and name	T1 – Free delivery threshold
Evidence	Data and research behind it
Hypothesis	Because we saw… we believe changing… for… will cause… measured by…
Variant(s)	What exactly changes (screenshot or mock-up)
Primary metric / guardrails	e.g. purchase rate per visitor / AOV, contribution per visitor
Audience and split	All mobile visitors to product pages, 50/50
Sample size and duration	Per version; start and end dates (whole weeks)
Tool and tracking	Testing tool; variant label sent to GA4
Decision rule	e.g. implement if significant at 95% and guardrails not worse
Result and learning	Filled in after the test

Example: the five tests in Lakaz Zepis’s Growth Plan

A model of what the "5 hypothesis-driven tests" part of your deliverable can look like (short form; the full plan adds the details of the template above for each test).

#	Hypothesis (short)	Primary metric / guardrail	ICE	Method and duration
T1	Free delivery from Rs 1,500 instead of Rs 2,000 removes the top objection and raises purchase rate	Purchase rate / contribution per visitor	8.0	A/B, all visitors, 4 weeks
T2	Sticky add-to-cart, delivery line and reviews higher on mobile product pages raise add-to-cart rate	Add-to-cart rate / purchase rate	7.7	A/B, mobile, 3 weeks
T3	One-page checkout with district drop-down and +230 pre-filled raises checkout completion on mobile	Checkout completion / AOV	6.7	A/B, mobile, 4 weeks
T4	"Complete the gift" cross-sell in the cart raises AOV for gift box buyers	AOV / purchase rate	6.3	A/B, cart page, 4 weeks
T5	Sending Meta ad traffic to the matching category instead of the home page raises purchase rate	Purchase rate per session / cost per purchase	6.0	Meta A/B test, 2 weeks

Test log

ID	Page	Dates	A: visitors / conv.	B: visitors / conv.	Uplift	Significant?	Decision	Learning
T1								
T2								
T3								

Checkout walk sheet

Step	Time (s)	Friction or doubt noticed	Idea
Product page → cart			
Cart → checkout			
Contact and address			
Delivery choice			
Payment (each method)			
Confirmation page and message			

SECTION 30

Glossary and checklists

Term	Meaning
A/B test	Experiment showing two versions to randomly split visitors at the same time
Above the fold	What is visible without scrolling
AOV	Average order value: revenue ÷ orders
Break-even ROAS	AOV ÷ contribution per order; below it, ads lose money on the first order
CAC	Customer acquisition cost: marketing cost ÷ new customers
Cart abandonment rate	Share of carts that do not become orders
COD	Cash (or card) on delivery
Contribution per order	Order value minus product, delivery, payment and packaging costs
Core Web Vitals	Google’s page experience metrics: LCP, INP, CLS
CRO	Conversion rate optimisation: research-led process to raise conversion
CVR	Conversion rate: orders ÷ sessions (or visitors)
Guardrail metric	A metric that must not get worse during a test
Heatmap	Picture of where visitors click, tap or scroll
Hypothesis	Testable statement linking evidence, change, audience, effect and metric
ICE / PIE	Prioritisation scores: Impact, Confidence, Ease / Potential, Importance, Ease
LTV	Lifetime value: what a customer is worth over all their orders
Merchant Center	Google’s free tool to upload product data for listings and ads
p-value	Probability of a difference at least this large if there were really no difference
Payment gateway	Service that processes online card and wallet payments
PDP	Product detail page
Product feed	File or connection listing products and their attributes for Google, Meta, etc.
RPV	Revenue per visitor: revenue ÷ visitors
Sample size	Number of visitors each version needs to detect a given effect
Statistical significance	Evidence that a result is unlikely to be due to chance (e.g. 95%)
UGC	User-generated content: customer photos, videos, reviews
Uplift	Relative change between variant and control: (B − A) ÷ A

Launch checklist for an online shop

- ☐ Payment methods tested on mobile with real transactions (cards, wallet, COD rules).
- ☐ Delivery zones, fees, threshold and cut-off times shown on product pages and in checkout.
- ☐ GA4 e-commerce events verified in DebugView; transaction_id unique; gateway referral excluded.
- ☐ Microsoft Clarity installed, sensitive fields masked, cookie banner updated.
- ☐ Legal pages live: terms, delivery, returns, privacy, cookies; BRN and contact details.
- ☐ Product pages pass the 20-point audit; images compressed; LCP 2.5 s or less on mobile.
- ☐ Merchant Center and Meta catalogue connected, diagnostics clean.

☐ Abandoned cart, order update and review request flows active with consent.

Monthly CRO routine

☐ Reconcile GA4 orders with shop orders.
☐ Review the Purchase journey and Checkout journey by device; note the biggest drop.
☐ Watch 20 Clarity recordings at that step; read customer questions.
☐ Update the ICE list; start or end tests according to plan; update the test log.
☐ Check feeds and catalogue diagnostics; check speed of the top 5 templates.
☐ Share a one-page summary: KPIs, tests, decisions, next month’s plan.